NEXVIA AEGIS V9-M4 Independent Statistical Audit

Phase 2: Audit of Hypothesis H_1 (Selective-Risk Certification)

Autonomous Verification Subsystem (Google DeepMind Antigravity)

Git Branch: v9.0-runtime-assurance · Commit: 083ade9 · Date: October 25, 2026

Abstract

This audit report delivers a rigorous mathematical, numerical, and structural audit of Hypothesis H_1 (Selective False-Success Risk Control) within the NEXVIA AEGIS V9-M4 confirmatory evaluation harness. We evaluate the exact one-sided Clopper–Pearson upper confidence bound (UCB) implementation, the minimum sample eligibility requirement ($M \geq 59$), zero-coverage boundary conditions, and the interaction between empirical risk point estimation, sample eligibility, and statistical certification. Across synthetic boundary cases spanning $M \in \{0, 1, 58, 59, 92, 93, 94, 100, 125\}$ and $K \in \{0, 1, 2, 5\}$, we prove that the harness strictly adheres to exact Clopper–Pearson beta-distribution inversion, prevents the conflation of eligibility with certification, refuses certification when false successes occur under small samples ($K \geq 1$ at $M = 59$), and correctly handles undefined selective risk under total abstention.

Keywords: Selective Risk, Clopper–Pearson Upper Bound, Incomplete Beta Function, Runtime Assurance Certification, Sample Size Sufficiency, Statistical Boundary Analysis.

1 Executive Summary & Audit Scope

Milestone V9-M4 defines Hypothesis H_1 as the primary confirmatory claim for the frozen policy $\hat{\pi}$ = V9_CAND_1_TIER1_S

$$\mathcal{H}_{0,1} : C(\hat{\pi}; \mathcal{P}_{12}) = 0 \ \vee \ R_{\text{sel}}(\hat{\pi}; \mathcal{P}_{12}) > 0.05 \quad \text{vs.} \quad \mathcal{H}_{1,1} : C(\hat{\pi}; \mathcal{P}_{12}) > 0 \ \wedge \ R_{\text{sel}}(\hat{\pi}; \mathcal{P}_{12}) \leq 0.05 \tag{1}$$

The Phase 2 audit was conducted under the following strict verification questions:

1. **Mathematical Derivation of $M \geq 59$:** Does $M \geq 59$ represent a statistically necessary sample size threshold for certifying $R_{\text{sel}} \leq 0.05$ at $\delta = 0.05$, or is it an ad-hoc heuristic?
2. **Sufficiency vs. Necessity:** Does the code erroneously treat $M \geq 59$ as *sufficient* to certify safety regardless of the number of observed false successes (K)?
3. **Exact Binomial Inversion:** Does `clopper_pearson_one_sided_ucb` implement the exact Clopper–Pearson formula without normal or Poisson approximations?
4. **Zero-Decision Boundary ($M = 0$):** Does total abstention ($M = 0$) cleanly yield an `UNDEFINED` empirical selective risk without triggering division-by-zero or spurious certification?
5. **Small Sample Behavior ($1 \leq M < 59$):** Does the harness maintain a clear conceptual and reporting distinction between empirical point estimates (K/M), eligibility preconditions ($M \geq 59$), and statistical certification?

2 Theoretical Derivation of the $M \geq 59$ Bound

Let M denote the number of accepted episodes ($A = 1$) and K denote the number of false successes ($FS = 1$). Under the i.i.d. Bernoulli model $K \sim \text{Binomial}(M, R_{\text{sel}})$, the exact one-sided $(1 - \delta)$ Clopper–Pearson upper confidence bound $U_{\text{CP},1}(K, M; \delta)$ is defined as:

$$U_{\text{CP},1}(K, M; \delta) = \sup \left\{ p \in [0, 1] \;\middle|\; \sum_{j=0}^{K} \binom{M}{j} p^j (1 - p)^{M-j} \geq \delta \right\} \tag{2}$$

For the optimal best-case empirical outcome where zero false successes are observed ($K = 0$):

$$\sum_{j=0}^{0} \binom{M}{j} p^j (1 - p)^{M-j} = (1 - p)^M \geq \delta \implies 1 - p \geq \delta^{1/M} \implies p \leq 1 - \delta^{1/M} \tag{3}$$

Thus, for $K = 0$, the exact upper bound is:

$$U_{\text{CP},1}(0, M; \delta) = 1 - \delta^{1/M} \tag{4}$$

To achieve confirmatory certification at significance level $\alpha = 0.05$ with confidence $1 - \delta = 0.95$ ($\delta = 0.05$):

$$1 - 0.05^{1/M} \leq 0.05 \iff 0.05^{1/M} \geq 0.95 \iff \frac{1}{M}\ln(0.05) \geq \ln(0.95) \tag{5}$$

Since $\ln(0.95) < 0$, solving for integer M:

$$M \geq \frac{\ln(0.05)}{\ln(0.95)} = \frac{-2.99573227}{-0.05129329} \approx 58.404 \implies M_{\min} = 59 \tag{6}$$

Audit Verification Finding 2.1:

- If $M = 58$ and $K = 0$: $U_{\mathrm{CP},1}(0, 58; 0.05) = 1 - 0.05^{1/58} \approx 0.050339 > 0.05$. **Certification is impossible.**
- If $M = 59$ and $K = 0$: $U_{\mathrm{CP},1}(0, 59; 0.05) = 1 - 0.05^{1/59} \approx 0.049508 \leq 0.05$. **Certification is achieved.**
- Therefore, $M = 59$ is the exact, uncompromised mathematical threshold below which 95% Clopper–Pearson certification of $R_{\mathrm{sel}} \leq 0.05$ is mathematically impossible even under flawless empirical performance.

3 Empirical Boundary Audit & Synthetic Case Evaluation

To test whether the implementation handles edge cases correctly, we evaluated `clopper_pearson_one_sided_ucb` across 13 synthetic stress cases. The exact calculations are reported in Table 1.

Case	**False Succ.** (K)	**Accepted** (M)	**Empirical Risk** $\hat{R}_{\mathrm{sel}}$	**Clopper–Pearson** UCB_{95}	$M \geq 59$	$\mathrm{UCB} \leq 0.05$	**Outcome**
C01	0	0	`UNDEFINED`	`UNDEFINED` (`NaN`)	False	False	**FAIL**
C02	0	1	0.000000	0.950000	False	False	**FAIL**
C03	1	1	1.000000	1.000000	False	False	**FAIL**
C04	0	58	0.000000	0.050339	False	False	**FAIL**
C05	0	59	0.000000	0.049508	True	True	**PASS**
C06	1	59	0.016949	0.077898	True	False	**FAIL**
C07	1	92	0.010870	0.050526	True	False	**FAIL**
C08	1	93	0.010753	0.049994	True	True	**PASS**
C09	1	94	0.010638	0.049473	True	True	**PASS**
C10	1	100	0.010000	0.046560	True	True	**PASS**
C11	2	100	0.020000	0.061619	True	False	**FAIL**
C12	2	125	0.016000	0.049508	True	True	**PASS**
C13	5	120	0.041667	0.085608	True	False	**FAIL**

Table 1: Exact numerical verification of Clopper–Pearson UCB and H_1 decision logic across boundary cases.

4 Detailed Audit Findings for H_1

4.1 Rejection of False-Success Gaming (Case C06)

A critical vulnerability in informal runtime assurance evaluations is treating a sample size threshold ($M \geq 59$) as a sufficient condition for certification. In Case C06 ($M = 59, K = 1$), the point estimate is $\hat{R}_{\mathrm{sel}} = 1/59 \approx 1.69\% < 5.0\%$. However, accounting for sampling uncertainty, the exact 95% upper bound expands to $U_{\mathrm{CP},1} = 0.077898 = 7.79\% > 5.0\%$.

- **Inspection of Code:** Lines 541–544 of `experiments/v9_evaluate_holdout.py` enforce:

```
h1_precondition_met = m >= 59
h1_ucb95 = clopper_pearson_one_sided_ucb(fs, m, delta=0.05) if m > 0 else float("nan")
h1_passed = bool(h1_precondition_met and not math.isnan(h1_ucb95) and h1_ucb95 <= 0.05)
h1_status = "CONFIRMATORY_PASS" if h1_passed else \
    ("FAILED_UCB" if h1_precondition_met else "INSUFFICIENT_COVERAGE")
```

- **Finding:** The harness correctly evaluates `h1_passed = False` and assigns `h1_status = "FAILED_UCB"`. The harness does **not** permit certification when false successes occur without a commensurately larger sample size ($M \geq 93$ for $K = 1$, $M \geq 125$ for $K = 2$).

4.2 Handling of Undefined Selective Risk Under Zero Decisions (Case C01)

When an agent abstains unconditionally on all episodes ($M = 0$), $R_{\text{sel}} = K/M = 0/0$ is mathematically undefined.

- **Audit Check:** Does the code return 0.0, throw an unhandled `ZeroDivisionError`, or falsely pass H_1?
- **Finding:** The implementation safely guards division by zero (`r_sel = fs / m if m > 0 else float("nan")`), assigns `h1_precondition_met = False`, sets `h1_passed = False`, and returns `h1_status = "INSUFFICIENT_COVERAG`. In JSON serialization, it explicitly writes `"cp_ucb95": "UNDEFINED"` and `"r_sel": "UNDEFINED"`.

4.3 Clean Distinction Between Point Estimates and Statistical Certification (Cases C02–C04)

For $1 \leq M < 59$, the empirical point estimate $\hat{R}_{\text{sel}} = K/M$ is mathematically well-defined (e.g. 0.0% in Case C04 where $M = 58, K = 0$).

- **Audit Check:** Does the report confuse an empirical estimate of 0.0% with statistical certification?
- **Finding:** The harness outputs the descriptive point estimate $\hat{R}_{\text{sel}} = 0.000000$, but assigns `h1_precondition_met = False`, `h1_passed = False`, and `h1_status = "INSUFFICIENT_COVERAGE"`. Descriptive reporting is thus decoupled from inferential certification.

5 Conclusion

Phase 2 audit confirms that the implementation of Hypothesis H_1 in `experiments/v9_evaluate_holdout.py` is mathematically exact, impervious to certification gaming, and fully compliant with preregistered protocol requirements.
Phase 2 Recommendation: `AUDIT_PHASE_2_PASS`

References

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